

PRELUDE

20-25 minutes

1. In the opening, the character is on a _____.

Ship or Boat

2. "But now I had questions about my family that only the _____ knew the answers to."

House

3. Look around on the ground. It is littered with missing posters. The person missing is _____.

Milton or Milton Finch

4. How old is the protagonist? _____

17 or Seventeen

5. Go up to the fence by the garage. "The house felt like it had always been here. Even the _____ was older than my mother."

Swingset or Swing

6. You get into the house by going through the _____ door.

Garage

7. "The power had been turned off _____."

The night we left

8. Only one restaurant would deliver to their house so they had _____ a lot.

Chinese food

9. "It was like a bomb had gone off, killing everyone but sparing the _____."

Furniture

10. The first house _____.

Sank

11. Who built the house (along with the music box?) _____.

Sven

12. "Edie told me once that every Finch that ever lived is buried somewhere in the _____."

Library

13. After _____ disappeared, mom sealed up all the bedrooms. Edie retaliated and drilled peepholes.

Milton

14. Based on the _____ on the wall, it was obvious that Milton had gotten to the secret room first.

Drawing

QUICK-WRITE

Pick a room in your house. Think about the way you or your family have set it up. What are some of the key items you notice in the room? Is there any art? What does the room smell like? How do you feel when you are in that room? Write a few sentences about what someone might learn or assume about you and your family and identity if they took a tour of that room.

MOLLY VIGNETTE

15-20 minutes

1. Being inside for the first time, it felt like I had stepped behind a _____.

Painting

2. What is the date of the last entry in the journal (what day did Molly die?)

December 13, 1947 or 12/13/47

3. Molly's mom sent her to bed without _____.

Dinner

4. The goldfish's name is _____.

Christopher

5. Molly ate all of the following except (gerbil food, toothpaste, holly berries):

- A. gerbil food
- B. the goldfish**
- C. toothpaste
- D. holly berries

6. Molly turns into a _____ first.

Cat or Kitten

7. Describe the game mechanics. What are you doing?

8. "Mom and Dad didn't even look at me." Molly says this while looking in the window as a cat. What can you interpret from this line?

9. Molly promised her dad she wouldn't climb the _____.

Big tree

10. Next Molly turns into an _____ trying to catch and eat rabbits.

Owl

11. After the owl, Molly turns into a _____ trying to catch and eat seals.

Shark ("I tore off her flipper and it tasted really good.")

12. After the shark, she turns into a monster trying to catch and eat _____.

People

QUICK-WRITE

Answer whichever one of these prompts you feel most drawn to. If you want to or have extra time, consider answering both!

1. Pick one object you own. It can be from your bedroom, another room in the house, or something you keep in your locker/backpack. How does this item relate to you and your identity? What does it represent for you? Why did you pick this item?

2. What is something about yourself that you wish more people knew about you? Why do you think people do not know this about you? Some examples you can write about: a personality trait, something about your culture, or a skill or talent you have.

BARBARA VIGNETTE

15-20 minutes

1. Growing up I'd always thought of Barbara as a _____ star.

Child

2. What is the title of the comic book starring Barbara Finch?

Dreadful Stories

3. The narrator of the comic book says that Barbara is age _____ at the time.

16 or Sixteen

4. Barbara's father cuts his hand on the _____ saw.

Table

5. After going in the basement, Barbara picks up a _____.

Crutch

6. Her boyfriend, Rick, was hiding in the _____ to try to scare her.

Refrigerator

7. In the music box, Barbara's _____ was left.

Ear

In the table below, provide the literal meaning of the narrator's figurative statements about Barbara:

NARRATOR'S FIGURATIVE WORDS

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED (LITERAL MEANING)

"And whoever he was, he couldn't get enough of Barbara."	
"She sensed the story might not be over yet."	
"The monsters had come to surprise her!"	
"Then she saw what kind of monsters they were and she realized what was going to happen."	
"She was going to be famous."	
"In her final breath, Barbara gave the performance of her life."	
"She had a taste for stardom, but so did her fans."	

QUICK-WRITE

Think about someone you look up to and consider a positive role model. Why do you look up to them? What do they teach you? How have they influenced your identity? Write as much as you can about them and how they have influenced you for three minutes straight, without putting the pen down. Do not worry about your grammar or spelling, just keep writing!

Write a **double ACES paragraph** explaining how Barbara died. You must cite direct evidence from the vignette.

ODIN AND CALVIN VIGNETTES

20-25 minutes (Two Students Play)

1. Edie told people that Sven was killed by a _____.

Dragon

2. What does this statement say about Edie's character?
What really happened?

3. The protagonist is also known as _____.

Edie Jr. or Edie Junior

4. For 500 years, the Finches had been famous throughout
_____.

Norway

5. All of the following people were on the boat journey except:

A. Odin

B. Indeburg

C. Edie

D. Sven

E. Molly

6. _____ Finch is the first to be buried in the family cemetery.

Odin

QUICK-WRITE

Everybody makes mistakes!
Sometimes, our mistakes teach us
valuable lessons. In a few sentences,
describe a mistake you have made
in the past, and what you learned
from that mistake. How did you
grow as a person?

SWITCH PLAYERS HERE

7. "_____ gave Sam an old camera he refurbished. He never put it down."

Sven

8. "My brother said he'd die before he ate another _____ and he did."

Mushroom

9. I think Calvin always wanted to _____

Fly

10. "After 18 _____ enlisted and never set foot in the room again."

Sam

***STOP AFTER FINDING THE BUTTERFLY BOOK**

WALTER VIGNETTE

20-25 minutes

1. "If there's a pattern in all of these stories....I think it's that none of us has gotten very _____."

Far

2. Walter has been down there for __ years.

30 years

3. "Even the _____ on the other side of the door starts to feel normal...even friendly."

Monster

4. "But I need to stop living the same day...even if it kills me." What device is this?

Irony

5. We find out in the end that the shaking was not a monster but a what? (How does Walter die?)

Train

SWITCH PLAYERS HERE

6. Walter's death is ironic. Provide evidence why.

7. "Trying to bury something that's still _____."

Alive

- 8 I think we've been surrounded by _____ for so long, we just got used to it.

Death

9. What kind of family finishes a cemetery before starting a _____?

House

10. Look at Walter's grave stone. What is interesting about it?

11. What is poking out of the water at low tide?

12. What's the difference between a monument and a tombstone?

13. Who do you think Sanjay Kumar is?

14. In what way did Edith already tell us she was pregnant? Cite evidence to support your claim.

QUICK-WRITE

Think about a time someone told you a secret and a time when you told someone a secret. Do not write either secret in your response, just use them for ideas. Write a few sentences that answer some or all of these questions: What is trust? What does trust have to do with secrets? How do you respond or act when people tell you a secret? How do you hope other people will respond or act when you tell them one?

MILTON AND LEWIS VIGNETTES

20-25 minutes

1. "She spent a summer building houses in _____ where she met my dad, Sanjay."

Calcutta

2. The beginning of the end was Milton's _____ birthday.

10th or Tenth

SWITCH PLAYERS HERE

(An experienced game player should compete Lewis's).

3. Lewis and I spent a lot of time playing _____ together, but he was surprisingly bad at them. He died a lot.

Games

4. In our sessions, I saw the same behavior....His mind began to...._____.

Wander

5. I had hoped he'd find himself, but he found something _____.

More

6. He talked about starting a _____. And he was always humming something.

Band

7. He held an election for _____ and he won. They begged him to stay, but his mind was already wandering. It became a game for him.

Mayor

8. "My imagination is as real as my _____," he told me. It was hard to argue with him.

Body

9. He began to despise the man with a _____ contempt.

Royal

STOP HERE

10. How did Lewis die? Why did Lewis die?

11. Who wrote this account of Lewis's death?

QUICK-WRITE

Think about a situation you've been in or witnessed that involved peer pressure. What happened?
How did you act? How did you feel? What did you learn from the experience?

EDIE VIGNETTE

15-20 minutes

1. I wish we'd stayed but I understand why we _____.

Left

2. What happened that night had been coming for a long time. Maybe it should have come sooner... but it had to end one way or another. All that's left now is to tell you about that last _____.

Night

3. The power had been shut off that morning, but Edie always had plenty of _____.

Candles

4. "The thing you're afraid of isn't going to end when you leave the house. Edith has the right to know these _____." "My children are dead because of your _____!"

Stories

5. They called it the lowest _____ in a thousand years.

Fog

6. I have seen the house every day of my life, but I never thought I'd go back to it. When the _____ rolled in, I lost my way.

Stories

7. I got turned around ... for a while I wandered. I started seeing things. Things I'd _____ had ever existed. But when I saw them, they felt like old friends. That night a lot of things came back to me ... or maybe I came back to them.

Forgotten

8. The next day the _____ came by, but she was already gone.

Van

9. The last Finch left alive until I found out about _____.

You

10. We find out at the end that the audience for Edith's story is actually who?

Edith's unborn baby

QUICK-WRITE

If you could sit down with Edie and ask her 3-5 questions about the Finch family, what would you ask?